

Event Information:

EventID :

303

Event Time :

Sep, 24, 2024, 08:21 AM

Rule :

SOC325 - Unauthorized Cloud Region Access Attempt Detected

Level :

Security Analyst

Source Address :

134.209.145.73

Destination Address :

52.15.206.21

Username :

test@letsdefend.io

Trigger Reason :

Too many access attempts with the same user were detected in a short period of time from an unauthorized (configured as "unused" or "unsupported") cloud region.

Request URL :

POST /accounts/login HTTP/1.1 403 512

Device Action :

Blocked

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 134[.]209.145.73 as the source and 52[.]15.206.21 as the destination in the relevant time-frame yielding 50 events. We can see what appears to be a brute-force attempt on 52[.]15.206.21.

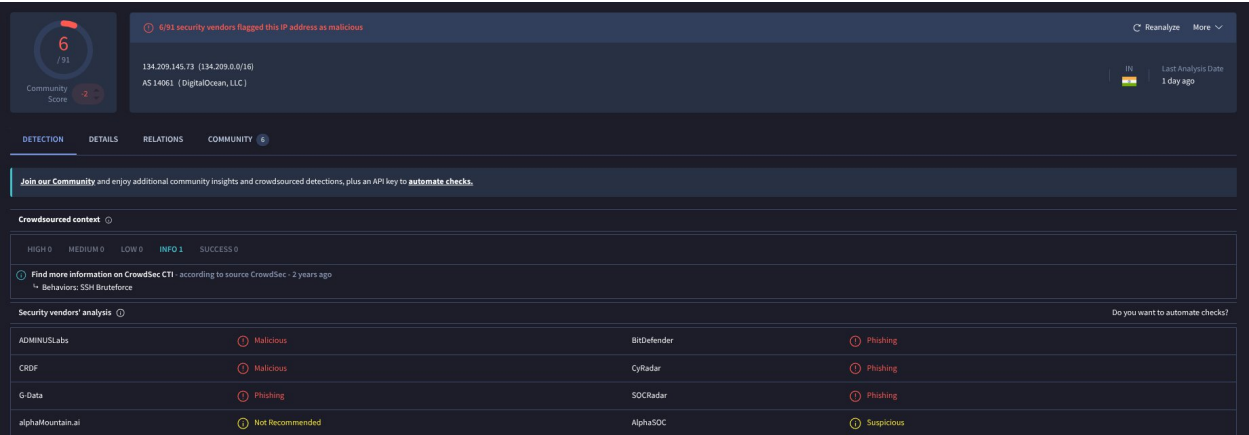
The screenshot shows a security log viewer interface. At the top, a search bar contains the text "Source Address contains '134.209.145.73' and Destination Address contains '52.15.206.21'". Below the search bar, it indicates "50 events (before Sep, 24, 2024, 08:21 AM UTC)". A table of event details is displayed, with the first event selected. The table has columns for field names and their values.

Field	Value
dst_ip	52.15.206.21
src_port	50231
dst_port	443
action	blocked
reason	access_denied
policyid	1
domain	app.letsdefend.io
url	/accounts/login
method	POST
user	test@letsdefend.io
msg	Suspicious activity from unused cloud region detected, connection ...

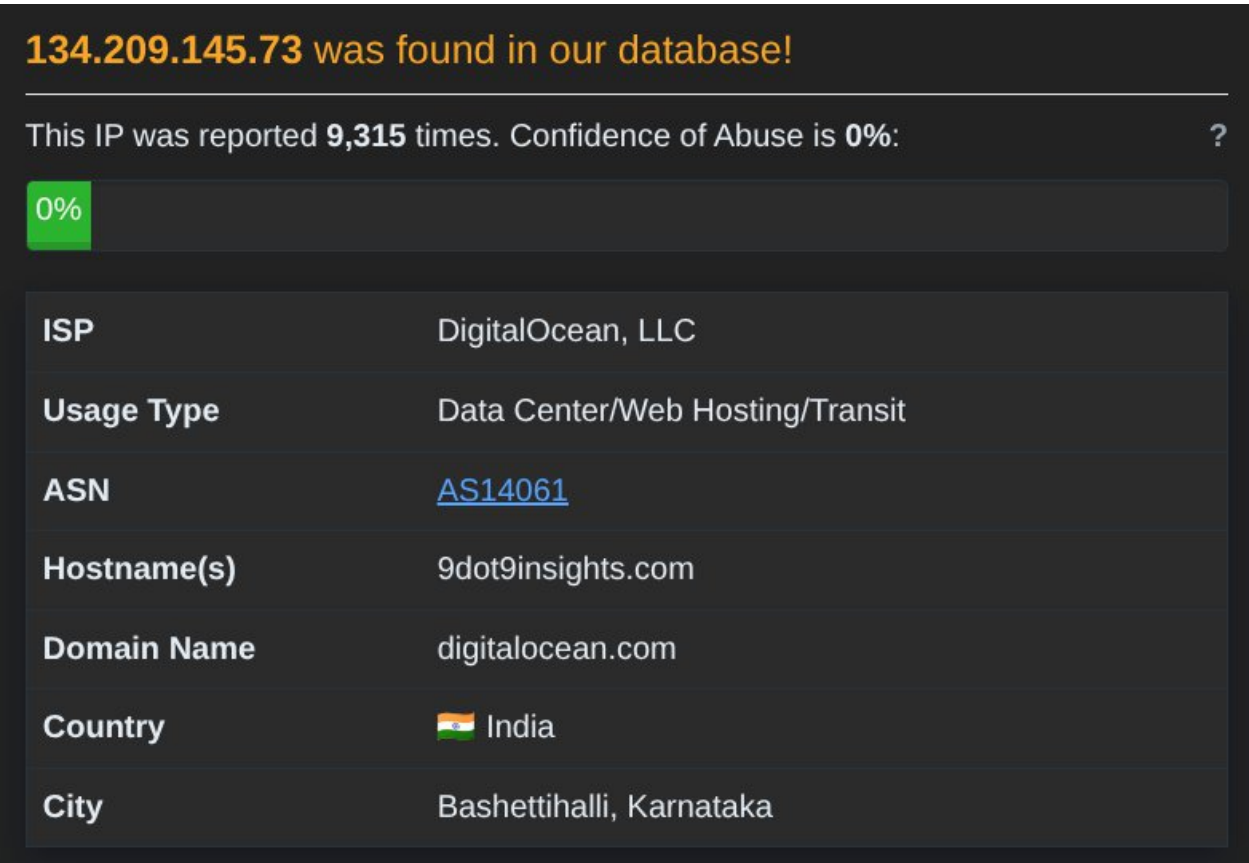
50 identical POST requests can be seen attacking the `/accounts/login` endpoint (specifically targeting `app.letsdefend.io`) in less than an hour, all attempting to authenticate as `test@letsdefend.io`.

The log details also confirm the device action was Blocked (returning an HTTP 403 Forbidden status).

The offending IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is an Indian address (which is what flagged the initial alert) associated with 134[.]209.145.73 AS 14061 (DigitalOcean, LLC). 3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 1 day ago.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 9,315 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.



Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a failed True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive alert for an unauthorised cloud region access attempt targeting the host app.letsdefend.io (52[.]15.206.21). An external threat actor executed a brute-force attack against the /_layouts/login endpoint using the account test@letsdefend.io. The attack was successfully blocked by existing firewall geofencing policies, resulting in a blocked action.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC325 - Unauthorized Cloud Region Access Attempt Detected
- **Target Host:** 52[.]15.206.21 (app.letsdefend.io) (Ubuntu 20.04.02)
- **Attacker IP:** 134[.]209.145.73
- **Device Action:** Blocked

Analysis and Evidence

- **Attack Execution:** Firewall logs show exactly 50 HTTP POST requests originating from the attacker IP in under an hour, all targeting the /accounts/login URL.
- **Targeted Account:** Every authentication attempt continuously targeted the same user account: test@letsdefend.io.
- **Defence Mechanism:** The source IP belongs to a cloud region designated as "unused" or "unsupported" by organisational policy (India in this context). Consequently, the firewall returned an HTTP 403 Forbidden status, blocking all 50 attempts.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The attacking IP (134[.]209.145.73) resolves to a data centre in India managed by DigitalOcean, LLC (AS 14061).
- **Reputation:** VirusTotal flags the IP as malicious with 6/91 vendor detections. AbuseIPDB lists 9,315 reports for this IP.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed firewall logs to identify a high-frequency brute-force attack targeting a single user account (test@letsdefend.io).
2. Verified the attacker infrastructure via OSINT (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB), confirming the IP is associated with known automated threat activity.
3. Confirmed the firewall successfully mitigated the attack via geofencing restrictions, dropping all connections.
4. Declared the alert a True Positive (Failed Attack) and closed the ticket.

Let's Defend Result

True Positive (+5 Point)

Should the device be isolated? (+5 Point)

Determine the Scope (+5 Point)

IOC Reputation Check (+5 Point)

IOC Analysis (+5 Point)

Determine the type of Defense Evasion Techniques Involving Obfuscation and Concealment (+5 Point)

Determine the OS (Operating system) (+5 Point)